

# 029 Make a bug hotel

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HR

Insects need a safe, warm, and dry shelter in the winter. Recycle scrap wood and natural items to make a bug hotel. In the spring, the bugs will repay you by pollinating your plants.



## What you need

- Pinecones • Thistles • Drilled wooden blocks • Stakes • Dry branches
- Stems • Wooden frame

**1** Ask an adult to help you use scrap wood, such as pallets, to construct a frame for your hotel. Ours is a big rectangle, but yours can be any size or shape.

**2** Insert stems, stakes, pinecones, drilled blocks of wood—any items that fit and contain crawl spaces for insects.

**3** Pick a site for your hotel. Make sure it's in a sheltered location, facing southeast or southwest, if at all possible.



**4** Hang it on a wall, or put it next to one at ground level. Cover all the compartments with wire mesh for more stability if you like.

# 030 Investigate a tree gall

15  
MINS

Galls are growths on leaves, branches, and bark caused by insects, viruses, and fungi. If you see one on a leaf or acorn, carefully cut it open—you could find a developing insect inside.

*Oak apple gall was caused by a wasp*

